Chris Cogbill

Principal ERP Consultant & Solutions Architect | 10+ years of end-to-end finance-system implementations (Unit4) across Europe & North America | Multi-entity acquisitions & cloud migrations | Sales bids: 11 of 12 won | AI tooling with Claude | Cambridge Physics graduate

Experience

SystemsAccountants

Jul 2025 — **Principal Consultant - Unit4** — *London*

I own ERP implementations end to end, from the initial bid and solution demo through discovery, design, build, data migration and go-live. This work runs across new implementations, acquisitions, cloud migrations and improvement programmes. I also mentor junior consultants and manage contractors on our larger engagements.

Key Projects:

- **Care UK:** Engagement began with Care UK's acquisition by Welltower (a US real-estate investment trust) and five care-home acquisitions migrated into Unit4. The client later returned, having first trialled a cheaper Unit4 partner, and I have since led the well-publicised **Danforth** and **Aria Care** acquisitions (~100 care homes across 50+ legal entities), helping grow Care UK into one of the two largest care-home providers in the UK. All delivered to tight deadlines.
- **City of Medicine Hat:** Bid for and ran an intensive Unit4 health check, shaping an ongoing improvement programme, now into its second year, including rewriting report templates to be cloud-compliant using AI.
- **Triton:** Bid for and delivered an integration between their internally developed AP system and Unit4's general ledger. Led to a continued support engagement for one of our more junior consultants.
- **Developed Report Migration Tool:** Built the rerx converter, a web tool built in Python that automatically migrates legacy Unit4 report templates to the cloud reporting format, replacing a manual rebuild of each report.

Dec 2022 — **Senior Consultant - Unit4** — *London*

Moved back to London after 5 years in the US, continuing as a Unit4 specialist with a mix of US, Canadian and UK clients.

Contact

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Technical Skills

Unit4 ERP (including ERPx)

- Record-to-Report (GL)
- Purchase-to-Pay
- Sales-to-Cash
- Planner (Budgeting)
- Fixed Assets
- Report Engine
- Integrations
- REST APIs
- Extension Kit
- SOAP Web Services

AI Development

- Claude API & Agent SDK
- MCP servers
- Claude Code
- Agent Skills

Back-end Development

- SQL (MS SQL, PostgreSQL)
- Node.js + Express
- Python

Front-end Development

- HTML, CSS, JavaScript
- React.js
- Git / Version Control

Key Projects:

- **Havas UK:** Implemented reporting for utilisation and client profitability, plus set up a REST API interface to Power BI. Leveraged existing relationships from US-based Havas work to win this project.
- **Medical Teams International:** Rescued a failing P2P (purchasing) implementation that couldn't raise a single purchase order when I took over. I delivered full purchasing with workflow automation and was later re-engaged for financial reporting advice.
- **Oanda:** Full planner and commitment accounting implementation delivered from scoping to production in under a month.
- **College of Medicine Hat:** Implemented the Unit4 Fixed Assets and T4A (Canadian tax document) modules.

Mar 2017

Senior Consultant - Unit4 *Chicago*

I joined SystemsAccountants' US operation (then 6 employees) and helped grow it to 100+ staff across three offices. The work with Havas made them SA's biggest global client by total revenue.

Key Projects:

- **Havas Worldwide:** Helped migrate ~60 agencies onto Unit4 ERP over 5 years. Predominantly worked across the New York, Boston and Chicago offices. Led Planning, Budgeting and FP&A reporting setup.
- **Havas Media:** Won and led SystemsAccountants' first large-scale implementation. Headed the consulting team across two phases including AP and Fixed Assets.
- Also delivered projects for the University of Toledo, The Reinvestment Fund and Hycite, and authored a successful Unit4 upgrade bid for Oanda.

Cogs Technology Solutions

Oct 2015

Independent Consultant *London*

I set up my own business providing consulting services and contracted predominantly to the UK Atomic Energy Authority (UKAEA) as well as to Methods (my previous employer).

Key Projects:

- **UKAEA:** Full-cycle Unit4 ERP implementation (HR and finance). Progressed from lead financials consultant to solution architect and delivered on time. Set up and trained their support team before departing.

Methods Consulting

Dec 2014

Senior Consultant

Apr 2014

Consultant

Jun 2013

Junior Consultant

I joined Methods as a graduate and was promoted twice in 18 months to become the youngest senior consultant across the group.

I delivered Unit4 implementations and upgrades for clients including West Suffolk Shared Services, Middlesbrough Council, and Macmillan Cancer Support.

Professional Skills

Sales

- Bid writing (win rate >90%)
- Presentations / Demonstrations
- Unit4 report engine demo on YouTube with >10k views
- Upselling — 6 clients who started with minor projects and later engaged us for upgrades / cloud migrations / reimplementations

Project Management

- Agile
- Waterfall

System Design

- Understanding complex requirements
- Implementing within system limitations

Training & Mentoring

- Mentoring junior consultants
- Managing contractors on larger engagements

Finance & Accounting

- Financial Reporting
- Budgeting Best Practices
- Month and Year End Processes
- US / Canada / UK tax
- Fixed Asset Treatments
- Multi-entity consolidation and acquisitions

Prior to focussing on ERP, I was part of the team that did the first Salesforce implementation into local government (London Borough of Hounslow).

Education

2009 – 2012

University of Cambridge

BA (Hons) Natural Sciences

Physical Natural Sciences — Grade 2:1

Side Projects & Ventures

- cogs.tech: a suite of small web apps I design, build and run, with shared sign-in, deployed on Railway and Cloudflare
- now / next / later: a task-tracking app that integrates directly with Claude
- day / week / year: a calendar that unifies other providers' calendars and integrates with now / next / later for task scheduling
- SharePicker: a share valuation algorithm and dashboard for FTSE stocks, tracked against real market outcomes
- FPL xP: a Fantasy Premier League expected-points model built on official Opta data
- Fantasy NFL, PL Picker and World Cup Pool: prediction games built for friends
- Clubhouse Mobile Mini Golf: founding investor in a successful mobile mini-golf business

Other Interests

- Voluntary Tutoring (The Access Project and Oxbridge Interviews) and Reading Help (Coram Beanstalk)
- Fostering and Adoption
- Rental Property Management
- Sport (Crystal Palace fan)